

How to build clear systems

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Oct 08, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/QE0d-jyNRgl> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Tim Luong outlines five core components for building clear organizational systems: standard operating procedures, role-based checklists, department playbooks, 90-day goals, weekly KPI dashboards, and company-wide data transparency.

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-  Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)
-  Checklists
-  Department Playbooks
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-  Weekly KPI Dashboards
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Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) 0:00

- The foundation of clear systems is getting everything out of your head and into a document
- Tim's current method for creating SOPs:
 - Record a long-form voice memo lasting **3–5 minutes** explaining the process
 - Feed that recording to an AI tool and ask it to write the SOP on your behalf
 - This removes friction and makes documentation faster and more consistent

Checklists 0:00

- Depending on the nature of a role, SOPs can take the form of checklists
- The creation process is the same as for SOPs — document what needs to happen, step by step
- Checklists are especially useful for repeatable, task-based roles

Department Playbooks 0:00

- Playbooks are more relevant to **department heads/leaders** than individual contributors
- The core question a playbook answers: *How do you actually run this department well?*
- Covers higher-level management decisions, norms, and standards specific to each department

Quarterly Goals & Weekly Meetings 0:21

- Every **90 days**, the leadership team meets to identify the most important priorities for the coming quarter
- The number of initiatives is intentionally kept small: **a maximum of 3–5 priorities** per cycle
 - Avoiding initiative overload keeps the team focused and execution realistic
- Weekly meetings are also part of the rhythm, keeping teams aligned on progress between quarterly sessions

Weekly KPI Dashboards 0:21

- Every department should have a **clear dashboard** visible on a weekly basis
- The dashboard ensures employees know:
 - Their key performance indicators (KPIs)
 - The most important numbers to track each week
- Consistency in reviewing these numbers creates accountability and early visibility into problems

Transparency & Data Access 0:43

- Transparency is a critical, often overlooked element of clear systems
- Key questions to ask about your organization:
 - Can **anyone** in the company access these dashboards?
 - Can they actually **understand** what they're looking at?
 - Do they know that data is being entered into them **correctly and consistently**?

The system only works if people trust the data and can read it — accessibility and data integrity are non-negotiable.